

STAGE FOUR • MINDSET, PRODUCTIVITY & HABITS

FIRSTS

SESSION PLAN

Three sessions, mapped and timed, to run all 25 FIRSTS as a live workshop

A Citrus Edition Facilitator Resource • Companion to the FIRSTS Manual

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FIRSTS • Session Plan

Stage Four • Mindset, Productivity & Habits

OVERVIEW

Stage Four's twenty-five FIRSTS span two source categories — Mindset, Productivity & Habits (twenty FIRSTS) and Extra Edge / Standout Factor (five FIRSTS) — split across three sessions: Mindset Foundations, Sustaining Systems, and Extra Edge / Standout Factor, kept as its own session to preserve that category boundary.

Unlike Stage Two's hands-on digital building, this stage's live work is internal and sometimes genuinely vulnerable — a confidence routine performed out loud, a resilience drill processing a real setback, a guided visualization. Build in the time and privacy these need rather than rushing through them as if they were purely mechanical tasks.

AT A GLANCE

Time	Segment	Format
Session 1	Mindset Foundations — E1-E10	~185 min
Session 2	Sustaining Systems — E11-E20	~165 min
Session 3	Extra Edge / Standout Factor — F1-F5	~95 min

SESSION 1

Mindset Foundations

Covers FIRSTS E1-E10: Confidence Routine, Morning Productivity Ritual, Reflection Journal, Resilience Drill, Time Management Matrix, Daily Learning Habit, Micro-Skill Challenge, Personal KPI Tracker, Focus Routine, Gratitude Habit.

PRE-WORK

- No advance preparation required. Ask participants to arrive willing to try things out loud, including something that might feel a little unusual at first (a confidence routine performed together as a group).

SESSION AGENDA

Time	Segment	Format
0:00-0:10	Welcome + framing: internal systems, not another round of self-presentation	Full group
0:10-0:30	FIRST E1 — Confidence Routine: design + live group practice	Solo, then whole-room practice
0:30-0:50	FIRST E2 — Morning Productivity Ritual: design + set reminder	Solo
0:50-1:05	FIRST E3 — Reflection Journal: first entry	Solo
1:05-1:10	Short break	—
1:10-1:30	FIRST E4 — Resilience Drill: peer-guided debrief	Pairs

1:30–1:50	FIRST E5 — Time Management Matrix: sort current task list	Solo
1:50–2:05	FIRST E6 — Daily Learning Habit: choose skill + block time	Solo
2:05–2:20	FIRST E7 — Micro-Skill Challenge: choose this week's skill	Solo
2:20–2:25	Short break	—
2:25–2:40	FIRST E8 — Personal KPI Tracker: choose KPIs + log this week	Solo
2:40–3:05	FIRST E9 — Focus Routine: live 25-minute focus block	Solo, phones away
3:05–3:15	FIRST E10 — Gratitude Habit + session close	Solo

FACILITATOR NOTES

- This is a long session by design; if running it in one sitting isn't practical, it splits cleanly after E5 (Time Management Matrix) into two shorter meetings.
- The Resilience Drill (E4) needs genuine privacy — space pairs out if possible, and don't rush this one even if time is tight elsewhere.
- The Focus Routine (E9) only works if phones are genuinely out of reach during the 25-minute block — enforce this explicitly rather than treating it as optional.

SESSION 2

Sustaining Systems

Covers FIRSTS E11–E20: Stress Management Technique, Accountability Partner, Learning Log, Habit Stacking Routine, Self-Assessment Review, Energy Audit, Goal Visualization Exercise, Affirmation Practice, Networking/Skill Challenge, Productivity Tool Setup.

PRE-WORK

- Ask participants to identify one person, inside or outside this group, they could genuinely ask to be a weekly accountability partner — they'll act on this early in the session.

SESSION AGENDA

Time	Segment	Format
0:00–0:10	Welcome + framing: today is about what keeps a habit alive past two weeks	Full group
0:10–0:25	FIRST E11 — Stress Management Technique: try one live for 10 min	Solo
0:25–0:40	FIRST E12 — Accountability Partner: live matching + commitment	Pairs or individual outreach
0:40–0:50	FIRST E13 — Learning Log: first entry	Solo
0:50–0:55	Short break	—
0:55–1:10	FIRST E14 — Habit Stacking Routine: attach one new habit to an anchor	Solo
1:10–1:20	FIRST E15 — Self-Assessment Review: schedule first review	Solo
1:20–1:30	FIRST E16 — Energy Audit: start tracking, set 3-hour reminder	Solo
1:30–1:45	FIRST E17 — Goal Visualization Exercise: guided group visualization	Full group, guided
1:45–1:50	Short break	—
1:50–2:05	FIRST E18 — Affirmation Practice: write 3 evidence-based affirmations	Solo
2:05–2:15	FIRST E19 — Networking/Skill Challenge: set this week's stretch goal	Solo
2:15–2:35	FIRST E20 — Productivity Tool Setup + session close	Solo, hands-on

FACILITATOR NOTES

- FIRST E12 works best locked in live, in the room — have participants exchange contact info on the spot rather than “messaging someone later.”
- The Goal Visualization Exercise (E17) benefits from dimmed lights and genuine quiet if your space allows; give it real room rather than rushing to the next FIRST.

SESSION 3

Extra Edge / Standout Factor

Covers FIRSTS F1–F5: Side Project, Volunteer/Impact Experience, Certification/Badge, Strategic Goal Sheet, Thought Leadership Post.

PRE-WORK

- Ask participants to spend five minutes before the session thinking of one genuine interest, cause, or opinion that hasn't yet come up in a professional context.

SESSION AGENDA

Time	Segment	Format
0:00–0:10	Welcome + framing: external, hard-to-fake signals of initiative	Full group
0:10–0:30	FIRST F1 — Side Project: idea + speed-round validation	Solo, then small groups
0:30–0:45	FIRST F2 — Volunteer/Impact Experience: identify cause + organization	Solo
0:45–1:00	FIRST F3 — Certification/Badge: identify + sign up today	Solo
1:00–1:05	Short break	—
1:05–1:25	FIRST F4 — Strategic Goal Sheet: 3 goals across skill, network, role	Solo
1:25–1:45	FIRST F5 — Thought Leadership Post: opinion + roundtable + stage close	Solo, then full-group discussion

FACILITATOR NOTES

- F1's speed-round works best in small groups of 3–4 — keep pitches to a genuine 60 seconds each to maintain energy.
- Close the full stage by having each participant name one specific system from this entire stage they're genuinely committing to using this week, not just one they liked in theory.
- This is a natural moment to preview Stage Five (Thinking, Reasoning & Mental Models), which depends on the consistency habits built throughout this stage.